

# State of the Web 2020–2025

HTTP Archive Trends in Page Weight, Protocols, and Security



Data Source: HTTP Archive

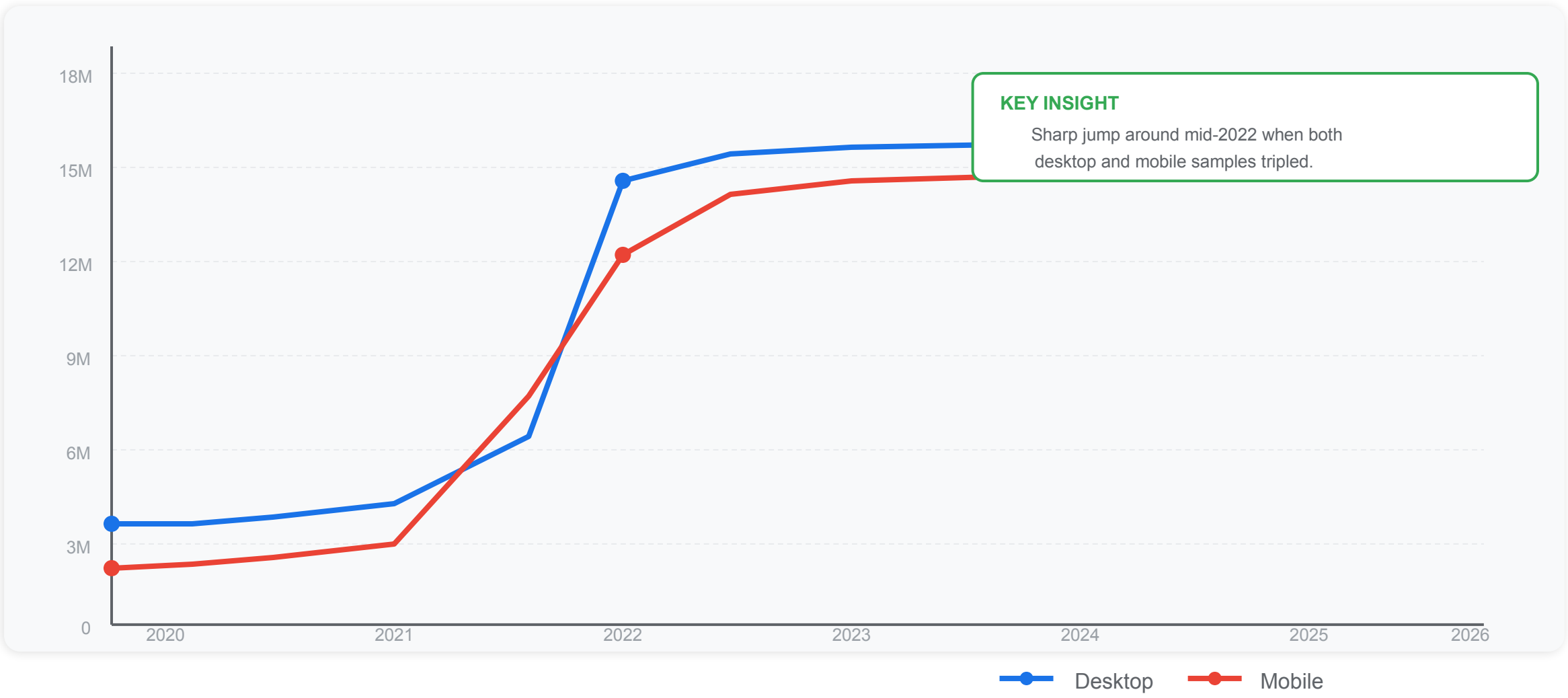
Jan 2020 – Mar 2026

For Web Performance Engineers and Front-End Architects



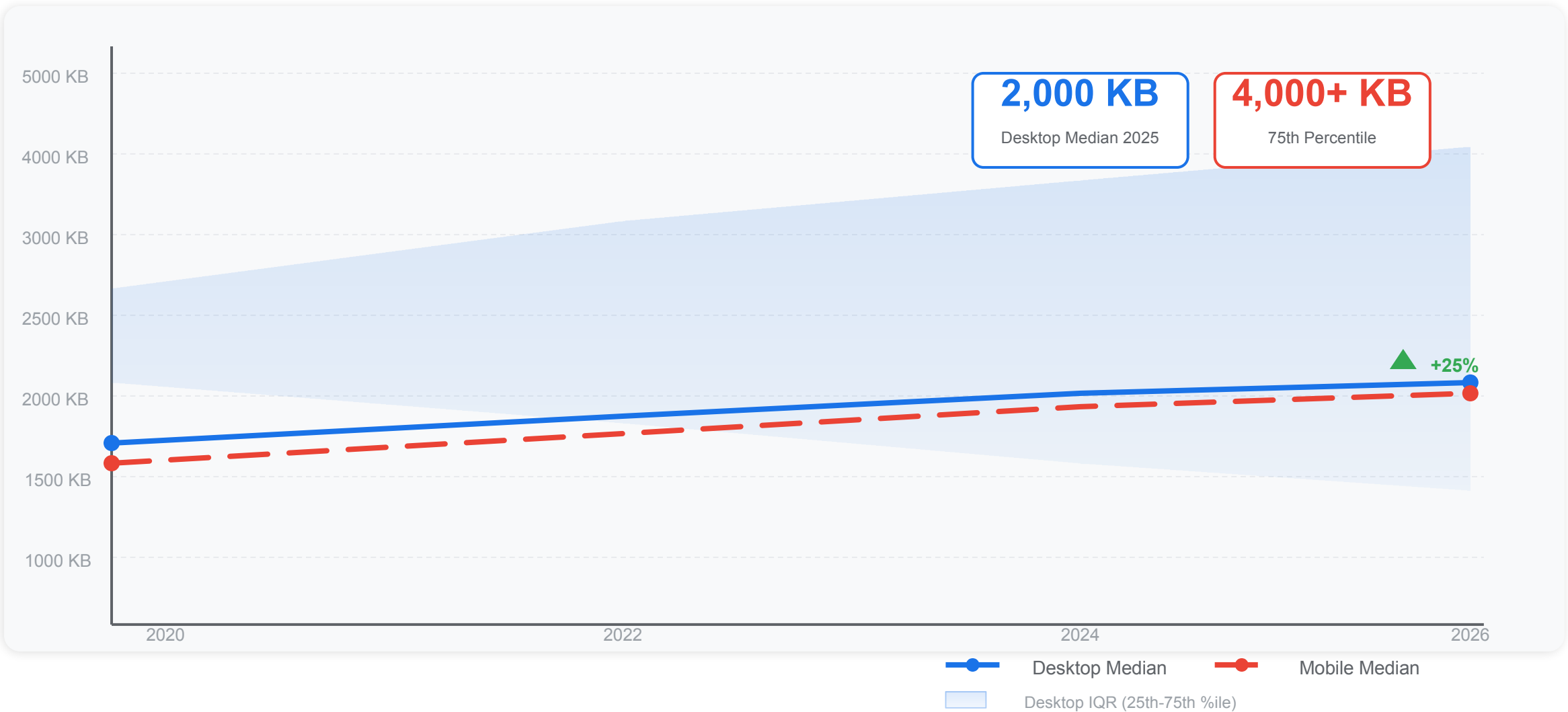
# Crawl Sample Size Tripled

From ~5M to 16M Desktop URLs Since 2020



# Median Page Weight Climbs Steadily

Desktop Median Rises from ~1,600 KB to ~2,000 KB with Long Tail of Heavy Pages



# 76 Requests per Desktop Page

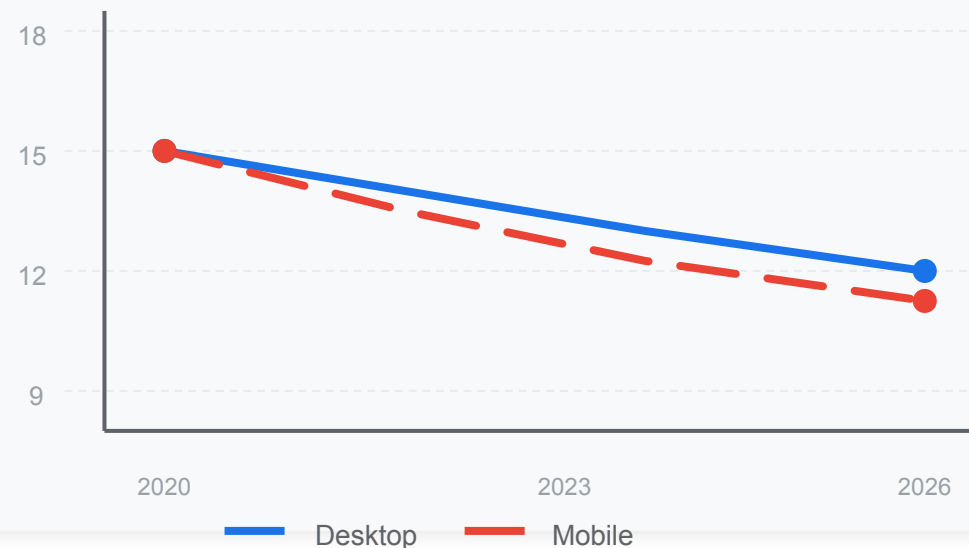
While TCP Connections Drop to 12 — Efficiency Gains from HTTP/2 & HTTP/3 Multiplexing

## TOTAL REQUESTS PER PAGE

Desktop  
**76** requests  
▲ +2.7% since 2020

Mobile  
**71** requests  
▲ +2.9% since 2020

## TCP CONNECTIONS PER PAGE (DECLINING)



### KEY INSIGHT

Despite growing request counts, TCP connections per page declined 15-27% due to HTTP/2 & HTTP/3 multiplexing benefits.

**15 → 12**  
Desktop TCP Conn.

**15 → 11**  
Mobile TCP Conn.

# HTTPS Requests Reach 99%

Encryption Is Now the Default — Plaintext HTTP Effectively Extinct

99%  
+



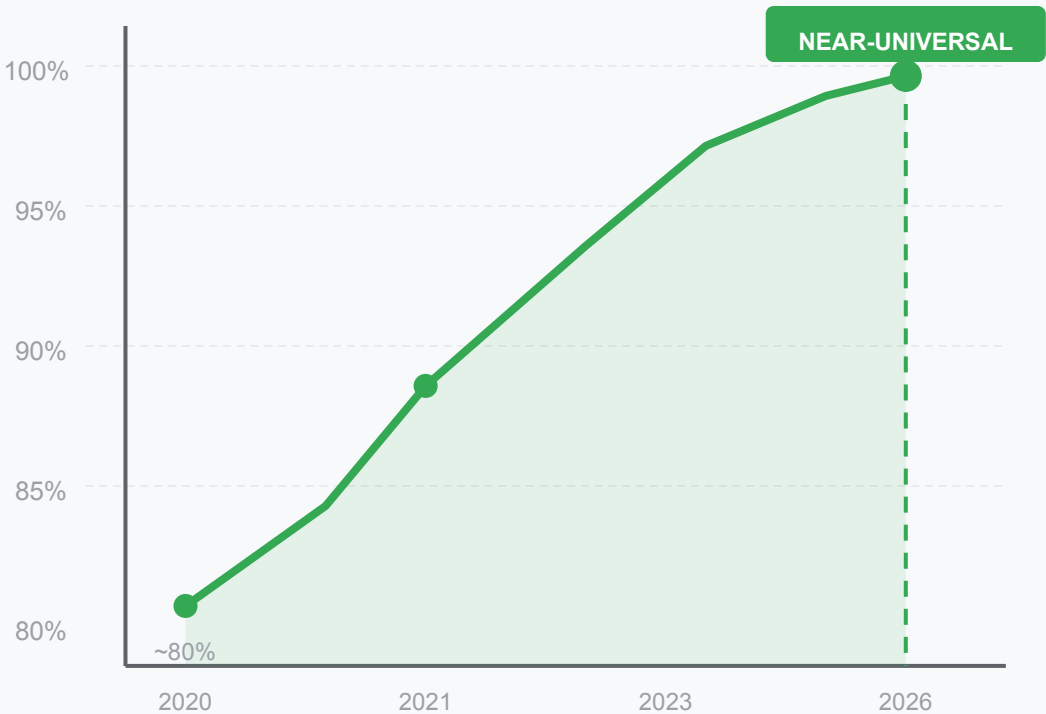
Desktop HTTPS  
99.2%



Mobile HTTPS  
99.1%

▲ ~19-20 percentage points since 2020

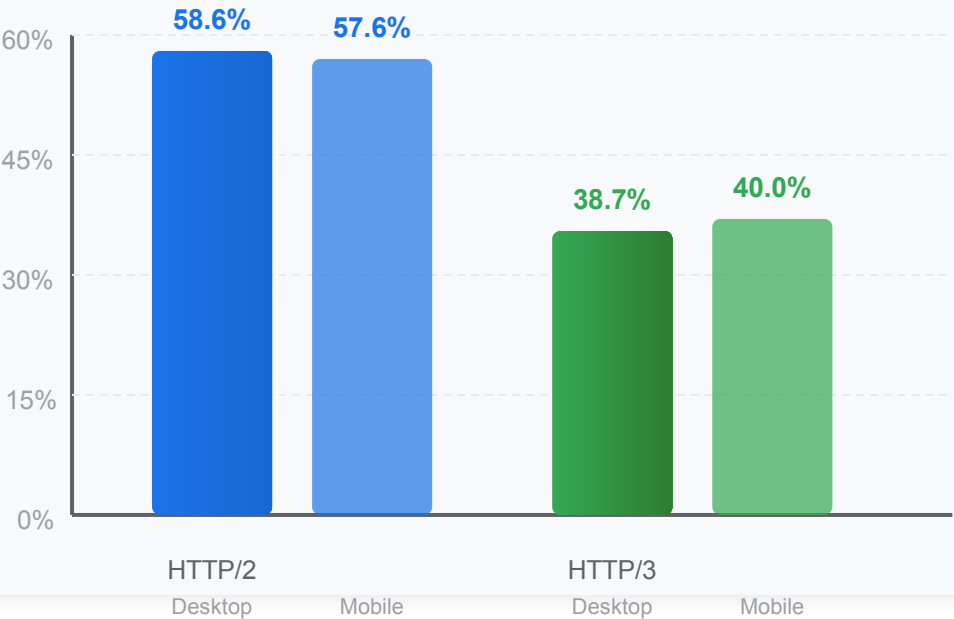
HTTPS ADOPTION CLIMB 2020–2026



# HTTP/2 Holds at ~58% While HTTP/3 Surges to 40%

HTTP/3 is the Fastest-Growing Protocol — Measured as Support, Not Actual Usage

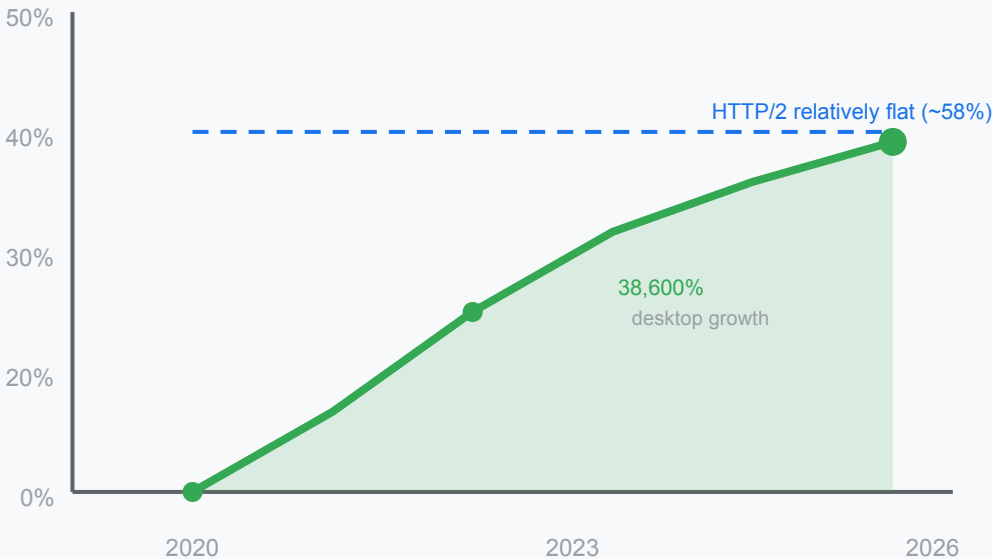
CURRENT PROTOCOL ADOPTION (2026)



**HTTP/2**  
**58.6%** Desktop  
**57.6%** Mobile

**HTTP/3 SUPPORT**  
**38.7%** Desktop  
**40.0%** Mobile

HTTP/3 SUPPORT GROWTH (NEAR-ZERO TO 40%)



**MEASUREMENT NOTE**

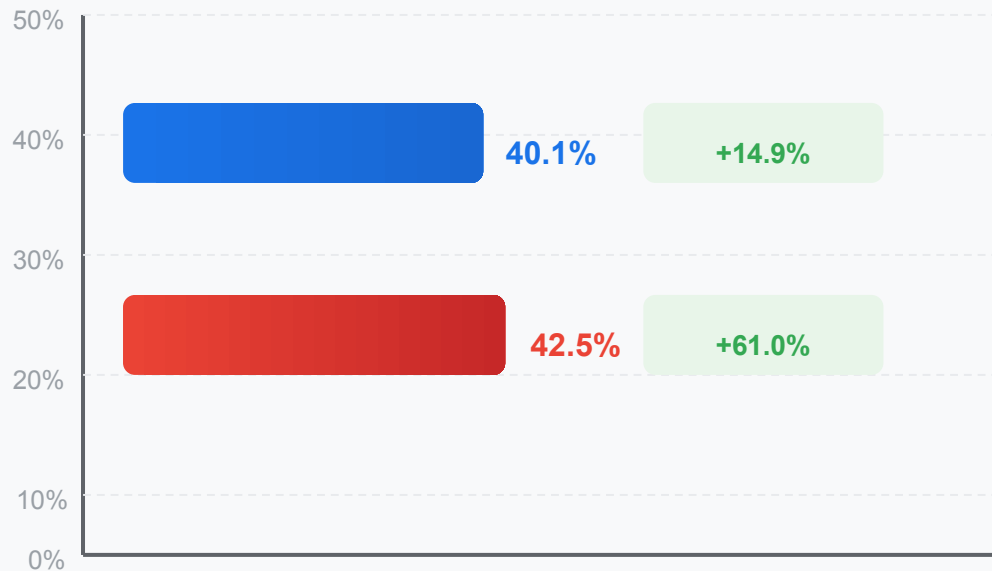
HTTP Archive measures HTTP/3 \*support\* not actual usage — fresh Chrome instances default to HTTP/2 on first connection before discovering HTTP/3 via Alt-Svc headers.



# Font-Display Usage Reaches 42% on Mobile

FOIT (Flash of Invisible Text) Avoidance Growing — Still Room for Improvement

FONT-DISPLAY ADOPTION RATE

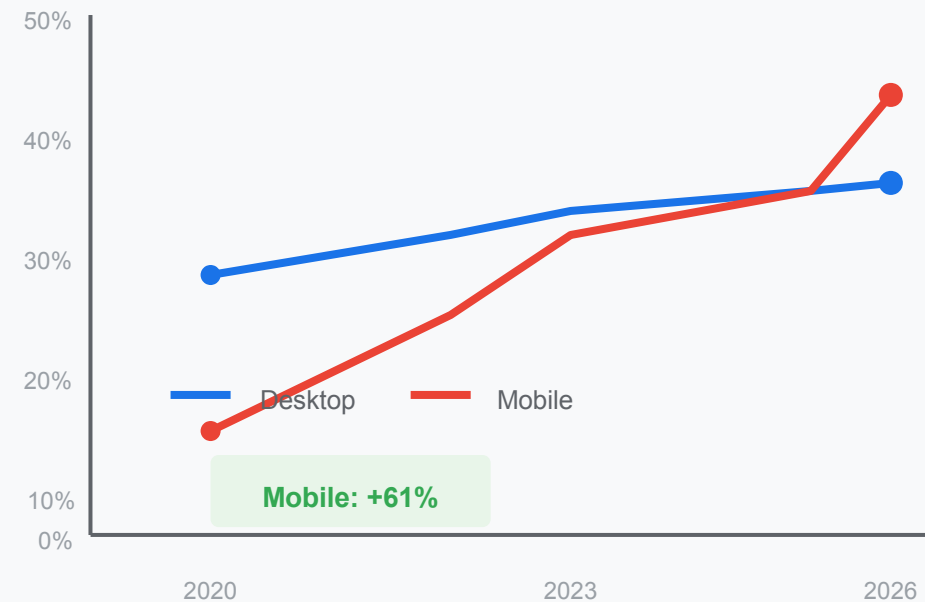


Adoption Rate

## WHAT IS FONT-DISPLAY?

The font-display CSS property controls font loading behavior, avoiding Flash of Invisible Text (FOIT) during web font loading.

GROWTH TRAJECTORY 2020–2026



## OPPORTUNITY

More than half of pages still risk FOIT. font-display adoption presents a quick win for user experience.

# Key Takeaways

Bigger Pages, Smarter Protocols, Stronger Security

## 1 PAGE WEIGHT

Median desktop pages now transfer ~2,000 KB, roughly 25% heavier than in 2020, driven by richer media and JavaScript.

## 2 HTTPS UNIVERSAL

At 99%+ of requests, unencrypted HTTP is essentially extinct on the modern web. Encryption is now the default, not the exception.

## 3 HTTP/3 FASTEST GROWTH

From near-zero to ~40% support in under four years, HTTP/3 is rapidly becoming mainstream with multiplexing benefits.

## 4 FEWER CONNECTIONS

Multiplexing in HTTP/2 and HTTP/3 has cut median TCP connections per page by 15-27%, improving network efficiency.

## 5 FONT-DISPLAY

At ~40-42% adoption, significant room for improvement in avoiding invisible text during font loading. Quick win for UX improvement.

## BENCHMARK YOUR SITE

Compare your pages against these HTTP Archive baselines to identify optimization opportunities.

DESKTOP PAGE WEIGHT

**~2,000 KB**

HTTPS ADOPTION

**99%+**

HTTP/3 SUPPORT

**~40%**

TCP CONNECTIONS

**12**

FONT-DISPLAY

**~42%**